

Shades of Hue

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I. Core Principles and Code of Conduct

1. **Mission Alignment:** All panel organizations must actively align with the mission of supporting and empowering the queer community. Adherence to a strict **Non-Discrimination Policy** based on sexual orientation, gender identity, religion, background, or ability is mandatory.
2. **Respect and Professionalism:** We enforce a **Zero-Tolerance Policy** for rude, aggressive, discriminatory, or harassing behavior. Professionalism is expected at all times toward customers, platform users, and Shades of Hue administrators.
3. **Prioritization of Stakeholders:** The platform is dedicated to ensuring the **highest quality service and privacy for our customers** while providing clear operational guidelines and fair support for our **Partner Organizations**.

II. Customer Privacy and Data Protection Policy

1. **Anonymity & Confidentiality:** User data is encrypted and handled in strict confidence. Customers have the right to maintain a degree of anonymity until they choose to share further details directly with a partner organization.
2. **Limited Information Disclosure to Partners:** Upon a confirmed match, partner organizations will **only be provided with the minimal, non-sensitive identifying details** required.
3. **Monitoring for Safety:** For the protection of all parties and to maintain platform integrity, all **primary chat initiations within the Shades of Hue application are monitored** by trained administrators. This monitoring is solely for dispute resolution and policy enforcement (e.g., preventing poaching).

III. Service Request Management and Service Level Agreement (SLA)

1. **Request Acceptance Window:** Partner organizations must review all submitted customer requests and issue a definitive **Accept** or **Decline** decision within a maximum period of **10 business days (1 to 2 weeks)** from the time the request is assigned.
2. **Mandatory Decline Rationale:** If a request is declined, the organization is **required to provide a clear and concise reason** to Shades of Hue administration (e.g., capacity issues, specialization mismatch, conflict of interest).
3. **Optimal Matching Commitment:** Shades of Hue commits to matching customers with the most suitable partner based on the customer's needs and the organization's expertise, ensuring a targeted and high-quality connection.

IV. Accountability and Quality Assurance

1. **Grounds for a Strike:** A strike may be issued to a partner organization for instances of **failure to satisfy a customer's essential needs** or if a customer issue significantly escalates due to negligence, prolonged unresponsiveness, or poor conduct.
2. **Dispute Resolution Meeting:** Strikes are not applied automatically. Before any strike is issued, a mandatory **Dispute Resolution Meeting** will be held. This meeting will include the customer, the organization's representative, and a Shades of Hue administrator, who will objectively review all facts and testimony to render a final decision.
3. **Suspension Protocol:** An organization with **strike** will not be able to receive new customer leads and **suspended for thirty (30) days/one (1) calendar month**.
4. **Account Deletion Protocol:** An organization with 3 or more **strikes; their account will be deleted permanently**.
5. **Continuity of Service:** Crucially, the suspension only restricts new leads. The organization **must continue and complete all ongoing services, projects, or existing client relationships** during the suspension period without interruption.

V. Ethical Conduct, Partner Protection, and Termination

1. **Zero-Tolerance for Customer Poaching:** Any attempt by a partner organization to solicit, recruit, or poach a customer outside of the Shades of Hue platform where the initial engagement was facilitated and monitored via our app's chat will result in the **immediate and permanent termination** of the organization's account and its listing.
2. **Mandatory Reporting of Issues:** Partner organizations are **required to report any disruptive, abusive, or problematic behavior** from a customer to the Shades of Hue administration at the earliest opportunity for intervention and support.
3. **Voluntary Termination Notice:** If a partner organization decides to terminate its relationship with Shades of Hue, they are **required to serve a mandatory 30-day termination period**. During this period, they must complete all existing commitments and may not accept any new leads.

VI. Platform Communication and Policy Changes

1. **Advance Notice for Major Changes:** Shades of Hue is committed to transparent governance. We will provide all partner organizations with a minimum of **15 days' advance written notice** before implementing any major changes to platform policies, guidelines, or core operational procedures. This ensures partners have adequate time to adapt and prepare.

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